

Power outage

ACTION CHECKLIST

Check the utility and local alerts, then deal with immediate medical, temperature, and water needs. Use battery light and conserve phone power. Run generators and other fuel-burning equipment outdoors, away from windows and vents; never use an oven or grill to heat a home.

[] Check the situation

Find the outage map and local emergency alerts. If someone depends on powered medical equipment, use the backup plan and seek urgent help if that equipment cannot run.

[] Make the space safe

Use flashlights rather than candles. Keep refrigerators and freezers closed. Unplug sensitive electronics if power is unstable, and leave one light on to show when service returns.

[] Keep air safe

A generator, camp stove, grill, or vehicle can produce deadly carbon monoxide. Keep fuel-burning equipment outside and well away from openings; use a battery-powered CO alarm if available.

[] Check your people

Contact neighbors who may need help. Conserve phone power, use text when calls are congested, and monitor official updates.

WATCH FOR

Headache, dizziness, weakness, nausea, or confusion near fuel-burning equipment can signal carbon monoxide exposure. Get into fresh air and call emergency services. Never enter a flooded area to operate electrical equipment.

Updated 2026-10-02 | General guidance. Follow current local instructions. In immediate danger, contact emergency services.

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/power-outage/>

CDC · Protect yourself during a power outage

CDC · Avoid carbon monoxide poisoning